G2: Subedar, 10 PARA (Cdo), Sri Lanka, 1988

Armed with a 7.62mm AK-series assault rifle with polymer furniture and folding stock, this officer wears the brushstroke-pattern uniform with a green headscarf and jungle shoes with puttees. The only web equipment visible is the cloth ammunition pouches, also of brushstroke pattern. He has a No. 36 high-explosive grenade and an M18 smoke grenade clipped to his uniform. The first Para Commando unit to be airlifted to Palali in Sri Lanka, reportedly for a '10–15-day operation', 10 PARA (Cdo), serving in 54 Infantry Division (**2a**), would go on to stay on the island for three years. The jungles were a big change for the 'Desert Scorpions', but they learnt and adapted fast even though they were armed with the obsolete 7.62mm SLR and the odd 7.62mm AK-47 assault rifle captured from LTTE fighters. They were later joined by the other two parachute (commando) battalions, making it the largest intervention by the Parachute Regiment outside India.

G3: Soldier, counter-insurgency operations, 1989

Armed with the 1A1 battle rifle, this lightly equipped soldier wears the M74 helmet. The Indian Army has been involved in counter-insurgency operations in north-eastern India since the 1960s. The units carrying out these operations undergo pre-induction training at the Counter-Insurgency and Jungle Warfare School at Vairengte in Mizoram. Initially, the jawans used the M74 helmets only and were lightly equipped, especially when operating in the north-east. It was not until the early 1990s that the Indian Army started using bulletproof helmets and jackets while carrying out counter-insurgency operations.